

COMPLETE EMERGENCY ACTION PLAN TEMPLATE

*A plan that works when it has to,
not just when things are calm.*

This template gives your organization every core component of a working Emergency Action Plan (EAP): chain of command, evacuation routes, shelter-in-place protocols, a communication tree, utility and vendor contacts, role assignments, and post-incident recovery. It is built around the core components outlined in [OSHA's emergency action plan standard \(29 CFR 1910.38\)](#) and [FEMA/Ready.gov emergency planning guidance](#), and it works for any industry, any building, any headcount.



HOW TO ACTUALLY USE THIS TEMPLATE

- 01** Fill in every bracketed field with your organization's real information. Placeholder text protects no one.
- 02** Assign a real name and a real backup to every role. "TBD" is not an emergency contact.
- 03** Walk through this plan with leadership at least once a year, and again after any major staffing or facility change.
- 04** Store a printed copy somewhere people can grab it fast, plus a digital copy somewhere people can find it fast.
- 05** Pair this document with an actual site map. Section 2 has a placeholder built for exactly that.



WHAT'S INSIDE

- | | |
|--|---|
| 01 Chain of Command Structure | 05 Utility & Vendor Contact List |
| 02 Evacuation Map & Assembly Points | 06 Employee Emergency Role Assignments |
| 03 Shelter-in-Place Protocols | 07 Post-Incident Recovery Checklist |
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Grounded in OSHA emergency preparedness standards and Ready.gov / FEMA planning guidance. A planning aid, not a substitute for a professional facility risk assessment.



WHO'S IN CHARGE WHEN THINGS GO SIDeways

Every emergency plan lives or dies on this page. List the people responsible for making decisions during an incident, and make sure every name below knows their role before an emergency, not during one.

ROLE	PRIMARY CONTACT	PHONE	BACKUP CONTACT	BACKUP PHONE
Emergency Coordinator				
Deputy Emergency Coordinator				
Facility / Site Manager				
Floor Warden(s)				
Department Safety Liaison				
Security Lead				
IT / Systems Lead				
Communications Lead				



THE RULE THAT MATTERS MOST:

the Emergency Coordinator has final authority during an incident, full stop. Put that sentence in front of every person on this list before you need it to be true.



GET EVERYONE OUT: EVACUATION MAP & ASSEMBLY POINTS

Insert your facility's evacuation map below, with primary and secondary exits, stairwells, and assembly points clearly marked. A floor plan from your building manager or fire marshal works well as a starting point.



[INSERT EVACUATION MAP HERE]



Mark all primary and secondary exits, stairwells, fire extinguisher and pull-station and assembly point directions.



PRIMARY EXIT



SECONDARY EXIT



FIRE EXTINGUISHER



PULL STATION



ASSEMBLY POINT

Assembly Point Details

FIELD	DETAILS
 Primary Assembly Point	
 Secondary Assembly Point (if primary is compromised)	
 Headcount Responsible Party	
 Accessibility Considerations (employees needing evacuation assistance)	
 All-Clear Issued By	



WHEN STAYING PUT BEATS STEPPING OUT



Not every emergency calls for evacuation. Severe weather, chemical releases, and active threats often call for shelter-in-place instead. Define the trigger, the location, and the reentry signal for each scenario your facility could realistically face.

TRIGGER EVENT	SHELTER LOCATION	EST. DURATION	REENTRY SIGNAL
 Severe Weather / Tornado			
 Active Threat			
 Chemical / HazMat Release			
 Air Quality Event			

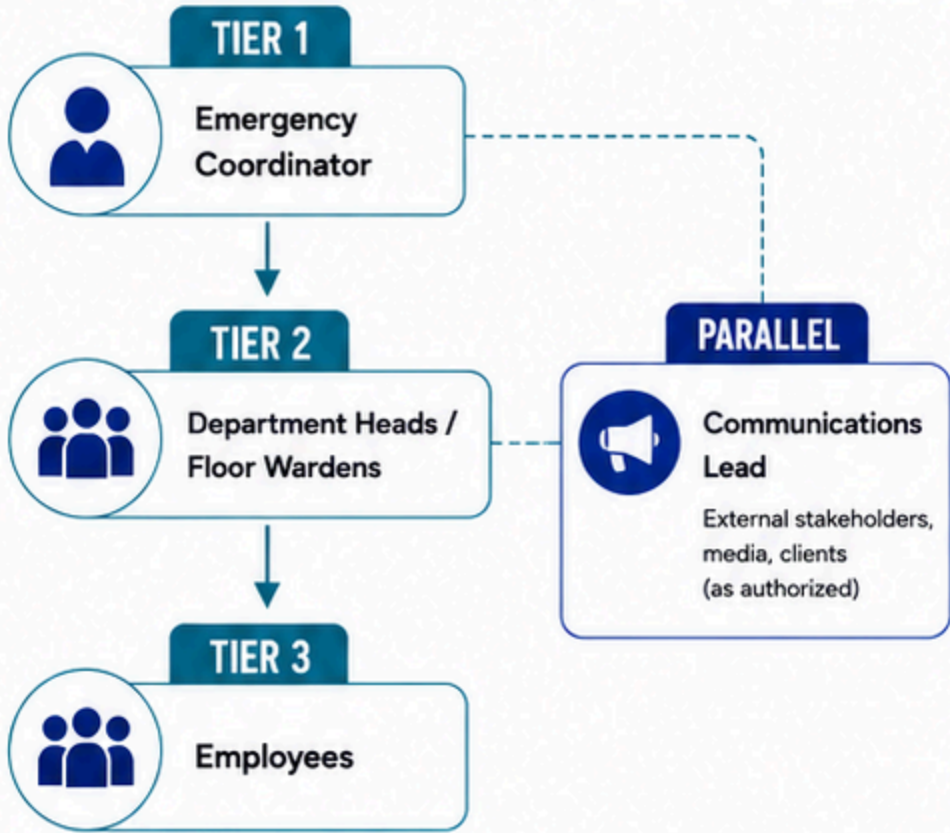
SHELTER-IN-PLACE SUPPLY CHECKLIST

- ☐ Water (minimum **1 gallon per person per day for at least 72 hours**, per Ready.gov guidance)
- ☐ Battery or hand-crank powered radio
- ☐ Flashlights and extra batteries
- ☐ First aid kit
- ☐ Basic tools (to shut off utilities if instructed)
- ☐ Plastic sheeting and duct tape (for chemical/air events)
- ☐ Non-perishable food, 3-day supply
- ☐ List of medications and essential medical needs for staff



WHO CALLS WHO: COMMUNICATION TREE TEMPLATE

A communication tree keeps one person from having to call fifty people alone. Each tier notifies the tier below it, so information moves fast without bottlenecking at the top. Of course, if someone in the chain is missing or unreachable, continue down the chain as appropriate to keep information moving.



Tier	Role / Name	Notifies	Phone
Tier 1	Emergency Coordinator	Deputy Coordinator, Department Heads	
Tier 2	Department Heads / Floor Wardens	Employees within their department or floor	
Tier 3	Employees	Immediate supervisor, confirm safety status	
Parallel	Communications Lead	External stakeholders, media, clients (as authorized)	



BACKUP CHANNEL:

Agree on one method that doesn't depend on the building's power or Wi-Fi (a phone tree, a group text via personal cell numbers, or a designated external contact who relays messages).

Name it here: _____



NUMBERS YOU DON'T WANT TO BE SEARCHING FOR

The utility and vendor contacts nobody remembers under pressure. Fill them in now, while you have time to look them up.



Service Provider	Acct / Site ID	Phone	After-Hours Line
Electric			
Gas			
Water			
Fire Alarm Monitoring			
Elevator Service			
HVAC			
IT / Network			
Security System			
Property Mgmt / Landlord			



EVERYONE HAS A JOB: EMPLOYEE EMERGENCY ROLE ASSIGNMENTS

Emergencies go smoother when responsibility is assigned in advance instead of improvised in the moment. List who does what, and who steps in if that person is out sick or off-site.

[illegible]

PRIMARY ROLE



RESPONSIBILITY



BACKUP



THE PLAN AFTER THE PLAN: POST-INCIDENT RECOVERY CHECKLIST

The emergency ending doesn't mean the work is done. Use this checklist in the hours and days after an incident to recover safely and capture lessons before they fade.

☐


Confirm all employees are accounted for and safe

☐


Notify leadership and any required external agencies

☐


Document the incident: what happened, when, where, who was involved, and immediate actions taken

☐


Preserve evidence and secure the area (if applicable and safe to do so)

☐


Update this EAP based on lessons learned from the incident

☐


Communicate a clear reentry timeline to all employees and confirm that critical systems and hazards are addressed

☐


Provide access to employee assistance resources and check in on staff well-being

☐


Schedule a follow-up review of this plan and training after recovery



THIS PLAN IS ONLY AS GOOD AS THE LAST TIME IT WAS REVIEWED.



Need help strengthening your emergency preparedness?

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